



A PERFECT END TO A DEVINE JOURNEY

A long-time advocate for equal pay in sports, Sophie Devine's side winning an edition where the men and women earned the **same prize money** is the perfect way to wrap up this World Cup.

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Hours after the 21,000-strong crowd had dispersed from the Dubai International Stadium on Sunday, the New Zealand team — barefoot and with beers in hand — walked to the central strip where they had scripted history.

Leading the group was veteran pacer Lea Tahuhu, whose 'mom energy' around the team had given way to overjoyed boisterousness. The

players first tasted the ground, feeling its tiny blades of grass, followed by some joyous dancing. There was no outdoing a thrilled Suzie Bates in this department, as she went around the huddle and pumped up the group.

Much like the Australians did (and had done for years) when they won the 2022 ODI World Cup, their cousins across the Tasman Sea sat in a circle and raised a toast to a campaign that had been nothing short of miraculous.

Everyone aims to win World Cups, but when you enter a tournament with Australia, England, and India waiting to devour you at first sight, a